

SOP: REFUND REQUEST PROCESSING

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Department	Call Center Operations

Applies to: All Tier 1 agents. Fraud cases route directly to Tier 2 — do not process at Tier 1.

Steps

Step 1: Open Call & Verify Identity

Precondition	Call connected. Recording notification not yet given.
Action	Deliver greeting script. State recording notification if not played by IVR. Verify customer using 3 of 5 identifiers. No refund discussion may begin until verification is complete.
Output	Customer verified. OK to proceed.
Policy Ref	CS-RULE-001, CS-RULE-002, CS-RULE-004, CS-RULE-005

Step 2: Identify the Refund Reason

Precondition	Verification complete.
Action	Ask customer to describe the issue. Map the complaint to one of five eligible categories: Service Outage > 24h, Billing Error, Speed < 50% of plan, Cooling-Off Period (within 14 days), Unauthorized Charge. If no category matches, proceed to Step 3 before declining.
Output	Refund category identified or flagged as unclear.
Policy Ref	FIN-RULE-001

Step 3: Validate the Claim

Precondition	Refund category identified.
Action	Pull system evidence. Outage: check Network Operations logs or incident ticket. Billing Error: compare current vs. previous bill line-by-line. Speed Issue: review hardwired speed test history only (WiFi tests invalid). Cooling-Off: confirm contract start date is within 14 days. Fraud: flag account and transfer to Tier 2 immediately — do not attempt resolution.
Output	Claim confirmed with system evidence, or fraud routed to Tier 2.
Policy Ref	FIN-RULE-002, FIN-RULE-003, FIN-RULE-008

Step 4: Calculate Compensation

Precondition	Claim validated.
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Action	Apply compensation matrix (FIN-POL-03 Section 2.2). Outage < 24h: apology only. 24–72h: (days ÷ 30) × monthly charge. > 72h: full month credit + \$10 goodwill. Billing error: 100% reversal. Missed appt (1st): \$25. Missed appt (repeat): \$50.
Output	Dollar amount calculated.
Policy Ref	FIN-RULE-001

Step 5: Check Authorization Level

Precondition	Amount calculated.
Action	Confirm amount is within your tier limit (Tier 1 max = \$25). If within limit, proceed. If above limit, submit Credit Approval Request to next tier. Do not communicate any amount to the customer until authorization is confirmed.
Output	Authorization confirmed, or escalation submitted.
Policy Ref	FIN-RULE-004, FIN-RULE-005

Step 6: Check Courtesy Credit Frequency

Precondition	Authorization confirmed.
Action	Verify the account has not received a courtesy credit in the last 180 days. If the billing system blocks the transaction, escalate to Tier 3 for manager override.
Output	Frequency check passed, or escalated to Tier 3.
Policy Ref	FIN-RULE-006

Step 7: Apply Credit & Communicate Timeline

Precondition	Credit approved and frequency check passed.
Action	Apply the approved credit code (ADJ-COURTESY or ADJ-OUTAGE) in the billing system. State: 'I have approved a credit of \$[Amount]. You will see this reflected on your next billing statement on [Date].' Quote the correct timeline from FIN-POL-03 Section 2.5.
Output	Credit applied in system. Customer informed of timeline.
Policy Ref	FIN-RULE-010

Step 8: Document & Close

Precondition	Resolution complete.
Action	Enter case notes within 5 minutes. Format: Reason Calculation Total Applied Ticket ID. Ask: 'Is there anything else I can help you with today?' Provide case reference number and offer post-call survey.
Output	Case notes saved. Call closed.
Policy Ref	CS-RULE-020, CS-RULE-021, CS-RULE-022

Special Conditions

- Fraud: never attempt Tier 1 resolution. Transfer to Tier 2 immediately. (FIN-RULE-008)

- Serial refunders (> 3 requests in 90 days): system auto-flags. Transfer to Tier 2. (FIN-RULE-007)
- Cooling-off refunds: no-questions-asked, but equipment must be returned in good condition. (FIN-RULE-009)